

TONY BAKER

Distinguished Engineer | AI Engineering | Software Architect | Senior Individual Contributor
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Target Roles: Distinguished Engineer | AI Engineering Lead | AI Architect | AI Product Engineer

Professional Profile

Distinguished Engineer and Software Architect with more than 26 years of experience delivering commercial software products, modernising high-throughput enterprise platforms, and designing resilient, scalable systems. Expert at translating complex business and technical challenges into practical solutions, with deep expertise in distributed systems, platform architecture, performance optimisation, and large-scale software delivery.

A hands-on senior individual contributor who bridges emerging technologies and business execution. Proven success architecting production-ready AI and agentic workflows, driving platform modernisation, and aligning engineering, product, and business stakeholders across global teams. Recognised for technical leadership, sound architectural judgement, and a commitment to building reliable, maintainable systems that deliver measurable business value.

Key Expertise

AI & Agent Ecosystem:	Agentic workflows, RAG systems, Vector Databases, Custom Agents, MCP, Azure AI Foundry, OpenAI APIs, Claude Code, Cursor, Prompt Engineering
Architecture & Patterns:	Software Architecture, Distributed Systems, Microservices, Event-Driven Architecture, Predictive Forecasting Platforms, SaaS, Critical Infrastructure
Languages & Frameworks:	C#, .NET, TypeScript, React, SQL Server, Oracle, RabbitMQ, C++ (legacy optimisation)
Infra & Enablement:	Kubernetes, Azure, AWS, Azure DevOps, CI/CD pipelines, Developer Enablement, Technical Strategy, Global Team Management & Collaboration
Leadership	Technical strategy, architecture governance, developer enablement, stakeholder engagement and global collaboration.

Career Highlights

- Reduced multi-team engineering configuration time by 90%** (from several hours to 15 minutes) by architecting a suite of self-service forecasting microservices that automated model setup, scheduling, aggregation and ensemble processing.
- Optimised production compute performance** to slash ensemble forecasting solve times from 25 minutes to under 1 minute, successfully replacing thousands of lines of fragile manual configuration with minimal auto-generated metadata.
- Accelerated organisational engineering productivity** by driving 100% adoption of AI-assisted development across cross-functional Forecasting teams in APAC and the US via practical workshops, pair-programming and safety frameworks.
- Founded and led the high-performing APAC operation** expanding it from a greenfield start-up into a 10-person regional business unit encompassing sales, software engineering, complex analytics, support, and regional business operations.

- **Architected enterprise AI proof-of-concept ecosystems**, including converting ~20,000 energy news publications into a vector-searchable knowledge base to power an agentic RAG chatbot featuring dynamic query rewriting and safety controls. This allowed C-Suite staff access to an AI Chatbot grounded in the articles.
- **Delivered optimisation of critical legacy production systems**, reducing API processing time by 82% (2m20s to 25s), improving workflow throughput by 80–99%, and lowering database CPU utilisation by 10–15% through targeted identification and resolution of performance bottlenecks.

Professional Experience

Distinguished Engineer

May 2024 – Present

Yes Energy | Auckland, New Zealand (Remote / Hybrid)

- Operate as a senior hands-on individual contributor directing AI integration, technical strategy, platform modernisation and cross-team developer enablement.
- Championed practical AI/Agent workflows, leading tools adoption (Claude Code, Cursor, Azure AI Foundry), agent and AI skills creation and building targeted internal micro-agents to safely augment core engineering pipelines.
- Designed and deployed production-grade forecasting automation architectures, centralizing system execution and decoupling dependencies on SysOps/reliability teams.
- Constructed robust Azure DevOps CI/CD pipelines and modular infrastructure patterns ensuring repeatable, predictable software deployment.
- Created specialised automated migration utilities to ingest and restructure substantial volumes of historical predictive forecast data (~38,800 records), resolving a critical commercial customer friction point.
- Maintained high code-velocity, consistently shipping production features while coaching teams on AI engineering practices.

Managing Director

Mar 2021 – May 2024

TESLA Asia Pacific | Auckland, New Zealand

- Directed regional business and technical strategies spanning core engineering, analytics delivery, support and international business development.
- Maintained direct engineering engagement, balancing high-level P&L oversight and senior customer stakeholder management with technical architecture and product delivery.
- Guided the Asia Pacific business through post-acquisition integration with Yes Energy while maintaining customer continuity and operational performance.
- Deliberately transitioned operational responsibilities (HR, finance, payroll) to intentionally realign toward a Distinguished Engineer technical track.

Regional Director

Dec 2010 – Mar 2021

TESLA Asia Pacific | Auckland, New Zealand

- Established the Asia Pacific operation from the ground up and grew it into a multidisciplinary regional business unit.
- Built long-term strategic relationships with utilities, grid operators, energy retailers and trading organisations across the region.
- Served as principal architect and primary developer of TESLAWeb, a globally deployed energy forecasting SaaS platform.
- Worked extensively across US, UK and APAC teams to support mission-critical forecasting operations and product delivery.

Technical Manager

Jul 2002 – Nov 2010

TESLA Europe Limited | Greater London, United Kingdom

- Led the engineering and delivery of critical commercial electricity and gas load forecasting applications.
- Architected, developed, and maintained core desktop and web-based analytical applications leveraging C++, C#, .NET, and SQL Server.

- Acquired deep specialised domain expertise in power market operations, translated complex analytical algorithms into production code, and supported major utility operators comprising over 85% of the UK power market.

Earlier Career Summary (1997 – 2002)

InstallShield Contractor | Barclays Bank PLC & HSBC AssetFinance (UK) Ltd (2001 – 2002)

Engineered enterprise-wide remote deployment and automated installation packages for internal banking infrastructures and Oracle database components.

Software Engineer | FFastFill Plc (2001)

Developed middle-tier electronic trading components, options/futures transactional utilities, and early framework migrations using C# and .NET.

Software Engineer | Trimble Navigation New Zealand Limited (1999 – 2001)

Built high-performance C++/COM components, graphics engines, and integrated GPS receiver hardware libraries within a core engineering group.

Assistant System Developer | MAF Quality Management (1997 – 1998)

Designed complex relational Access/SQL reporting databases to process large-scale laboratory proficiency datasets.

Education

Bachelor of Computing and Mathematical Sciences University of Waikato, NZ **(Computer Software Engineering)**

First Class Honours | Winner of the University Best Presentation Award in Computing and Mathematical Sciences

Availability & Work Model

Based in Auckland, New Zealand. Fully available for high-impact Senior Individual Contributor (IC) roles globally. Offers 24+ years of cross-border collaborative experience spanning EU, US, and APAC corporate time zones with built-in flexible working hours to facilitate immediate international alignment.